

LOOKING FOR EVIDENCE

Just because we believe our “hot thought” does not necessarily mean it’s true. You may be saying “but I feel like it’s true”, however, a feeling is not a fact. Feelings are not evidence for anything – they are just feelings. Indeed, feelings are real and valid, but the strength of your feelings does not prove the convictions of your thoughts. Remember, **thoughts are not facts**.

In columns 5 and 6, we write down the evidence that supports your hot thought and evidence that does not support it. Seeking evidence is not easy to do. We often come up with a lot of assumptions that we think are facts. What’s the difference?

Here are some examples to think about, try to identify which ones are factual:

- I could tell she didn’t like me by the way she looked at me
She had a peculiar look on her face. She said she was tired
- I know he doesn’t love me, if he did, he would know by now what I like
He did get me what I wanted for Christmas when I gave him a list last time
- All teenagers are lazy
My teenager does not care about how the house looks, like I do
- My friend does not want to be my friend anymore because she didn’t text me back
She did tell me that she has been very busy and stressed with a work project

FINDING EVIDENCE THAT DOES NOT SUPPORT THE HOT THOUGHT

Use the questions below to complete column 6 of the thought record:

- Have I had any experiences that show that this thought is not completely true all the time?
- If my best friend or someone I loved had this thought, what would I tell them?
- If my best friend or someone who loves me knew I was thinking this thought, what would they say to me? What evidence would they point out to me that would suggest that my thoughts were not 100% true?
- When I am not feeling this way, do I think about this type of situation any differently? How?
- When I have felt this way in the past, what did I think about that helped me feel better?
- Have I been in this type of situation before? What happened? Is there anything different between this situation and previous ones? What have I learned from prior experiences that could help me now?